# The Geopolitics of Cartography: A Toponymic, Legal, and Sociological Analysis of the North Atlantic Archipelago

## 1. Introduction: The Intersection of Geography, Law, and Toponymy

The act of naming geographical features—the science of toponymy—is a fundamental component of human civilization, enabling navigation, standardizing international communication, and organizing our understanding of the physical world. A toponymist applies established local and international principles, often developed in consultation with the United Nations Group of Experts on Geographical Names (UNGEGN) and the International Hydrographic Organization (IHO), to establish officially recognized geographical names.[1] However, geographical nomenclature is frequently subjected to the pressures of modern political statecraft, where historical, scientifically verified names become the target of ideological revisionism.

Within the English-speaking world, the most prominent example of this friction is the terminology applied to the vast archipelago situated off the north-western coast of continental Europe. Historically, scientifically, and geographically codified as the "British Isles," this macro-region comprises over 6,000 individual islands of varying sizes and political affiliations.[3] In recent decades, a localized political movement, primarily originating from the Government of the Republic of Ireland, has sought to discourage and erase the use of the term "British Isles," viewing it as an affront to modern political sovereignty and associating the term "British" exclusively with English imperialism.[5]

This report will systematically demonstrate that the rejection of the term "British Isles" is rooted in a fundamental mischaracterization of geography, law, and sociology. The narrative that Irish citizens are inherently "allowed to find it offensive" operates as a form of modern political propaganda that actively ignores the objective, verified geographical reality of the archipelago.[6] By analyzing the intricate Venn diagram of the region's overlapping geographical and political jurisdictions—ranging from the Republic of Ireland and the United Kingdom to the Isle of Man, the Aran Islands, the Isle of Skye, and the Isle of Wight—this analysis will establish that "British Isles" describes a holistic geographic ecosystem, not merely "one big island and one small island."

Furthermore, this report will deconstruct the sociological fallacy that "British" identity is equivocal to "English" identity, highlighting the rich tapestry of Scottish, Welsh, Manx, and historical Irish contributions to Britishness.[7] It will examine international maritime

law—specifically the naming of the Irish Sea and the English Channel—to prove that geographic naming conventions do not equate to sovereign ownership.[10] Finally, this report will contextualize the danger of political interference in cartography by examining the 2025–2026 geopolitical crisis surrounding United States President Donald Trump's unilateral attempt to rename the Gulf of Mexico to the "Gulf of America," illustrating why objective, historical geographic names must be defended against arbitrary political revisionism.[12]

# 2. The Geographic Reality: A Venn Diagram of the Archipelago

To understand the necessity and accuracy of the term "British Isles," one must first comprehend the sheer scale and complexity of the region. The archipelago is not a binary system of two islands, but a sprawling, deeply interconnected physical environment covering a total area of 315,159 square kilometers.[3] Attempting to describe this region using purely political terms, or fragmented geographic descriptors, fails to capture the physical reality of the archipelago.

## 2.1 The Primary Landmasses

The archipelago is anchored by two massive islands, around which thousands of smaller islands cluster:

1. **Great Britain:** The largest island in the archipelago, the largest in Europe, and the ninth-largest island in the world, covering an area of 209,331 square kilometers.[4] Geographically, it is located to the east of the island of Ireland. Politically, the entirety of this island belongs to the sovereign state of the United Kingdom and comprises the constituent countries of England, Scotland, and Wales.[14]
2. **Ireland:** The second-largest island in the archipelago, covering 81,638 square kilometers.[4] Politically, this island is divided. Approximately five-sixths of the landmass is governed by the Republic of Ireland, an independent sovereign state. The north-eastern sixth is Northern Ireland, a constituent country of the United Kingdom.[3]

## 2.2 The Thousands of Surrounding Isles

The true essence of the "British Isles" lies in the 6,000-plus smaller islands that orbit the two main landmasses. These islands are geographically integrated into the insular shelf of the archipelago, yet they hold vastly different political statuses, demonstrating why a unifying geographic umbrella term is absolutely necessary.

- **The Aran Islands (Republic of Ireland):** Situated at the mouth of Galway Bay off the western coast of the island of Ireland, the Aran Islands (Inis Mór, Inis Meáin, and Inis Oírr) represent the extreme western geographic frontier of the British Isles. Politically, they are part of the Republic of Ireland, yet physically, they are an undeniable component of the wider Atlantic archipelago.[6]
- **The Isle of Skye (Scotland, United Kingdom):** Located in the Inner Hebrides off the west coast of Scotland, Skye covers 1,656 square kilometers.[4] It is heavily defined by its

Celtic and Norse history, deeply distinct from English geography, yet it forms a critical northern component of the British Isles.[17]

- **The Isle of Wight (England, United Kingdom):** A large island located between 4 and 6 kilometers off the southern coast of mainland England, separated by the Solent.[16] It represents the southern geographical anchor of the British Isles.[17]
- **The Isle of Man (Crown Dependency):** The Isle of Man offers the most compelling evidence for the necessity of the term "British Isles." It is located dead center in the Irish Sea, almost equidistant from Great Britain and Ireland.[18] It is not part of the United Kingdom, nor is it part of the Republic of Ireland. It is a self-governing Crown Dependency.[20] Geographically, it cannot simply be called "Britain" or "Ireland." It requires a macro-geographic categorization, which is precisely the function that the "British Isles" serves.[21]
- **The Channel Islands (Crown Dependencies):** The Bailiwicks of Jersey and Guernsey are located off the north coast of France. While geographically closer to the European mainland, they are traditionally and politically integrated into the regional definitions of the area due to their status as British Crown Dependencies.[3]

| Geographic Entity | Area (km2) | Geographic Location | Principal Political Affiliation |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Great Britain** | 209,331 | Eastern primary landmass | United Kingdom (England, Scotland, Wales) |
| **Ireland** | 81,638 | Western primary landmass | Republic of Ireland / United Kingdom (N. Ireland) |
| **Isle of Lewis & Harris** | 2,179 | Outer Hebrides, North | United Kingdom (Scotland) |
| **Isle of Skye** | 1,656 | Inner Hebrides, North-West | United Kingdom (Scotland) |
| **Isle of Man** | 572 | Irish Sea, Central | British Crown Dependency |
| **Isle of Wight** | 380 | English Channel, South | United Kingdom (England) |
| **Aran Islands** | 46 | Galway Bay, West | Republic of Ireland |

As demonstrated by this Venn diagram of overlapping physical geography and fractured political sovereignty, the term "British Isles" is functionally indispensable. It is the verified, historical name for the entire ecological and geological area. To abandon the term because one sovereign entity within the archipelago (the Republic of Ireland) dislikes the political connotations of the word "British" is to prioritize subjective political offense over objective cartographic reality.[22] It is detrimental to the scientific categorization of the globe, as it breaks apart a unified archipelago into cumbersome, politicized fragments.

# 3. The Toponymic and Legal Verification of the Nomenclature

The argument that it is offensive to use the term "British Isles" relies on the false premise that "British" exclusively denotes ownership by the modern political state of the United Kingdom. This fundamentally misrepresents both the history of the region's toponymy and the strict legal definitions utilized in modern jurisprudence.

## 3.1 The Historical Antiquity of the Name

The root of the term "British Isles" predates the existence of the United Kingdom, the English language, and the nation of England itself by over a millennia. The earliest variants of the term date back to Ancient Greek and Roman times. By 50 BC, Greek geographers, including Polybius and Ptolemy, were using equivalents of *Pretanikē* or the "Pretanic Islands" (αἱ Βρεττανίαι) as a collective geographical name for the entire archipelago, including the island of Ireland.[6]

The collective name was a geographic and cultural designation for the broader Celtic populations of the islands, completely devoid of the modern imperial connotations of the 18th and 19th centuries.[23] The term was introduced into the English language in the late 16th century via translations of these classical geographies.[23] While subsequent colonial administrations undeniably leveraged the term during periods of imperialism, the underlying verified name of the archipelago has remained the British Isles for thousands of years.[6] A geographical reality cannot be retroactively nullified simply because the history of human conflict within that geography has evolved.

## 3.2 The Legal Distinction: "British Isles" vs. "British Islands"

One of the primary drivers of the artificial offense surrounding the term "British Isles" is a widespread lack of legal literacy. In the modern era, the term "British Isles" is almost exclusively a *geographical* term, not a legal one.[24] The United Kingdom does not use the term "British Isles" to assert legal ownership over the Republic of Ireland.

In fact, United Kingdom statutory law relies on a highly specific, distinct term to define its jurisdictional borders: the **"British Islands."**

Under Schedule 1 of the UK Interpretation Act 1978, the legal term "British Islands" is meticulously defined as comprising four distinct polities:

1. The United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland.
2. The Bailiwick of Jersey.
3. The Bailiwick of Guernsey.
4. The Isle of Man.[25]

This statutory definition actively, legally, and permanently excludes the Republic of Ireland.[25] Since the establishment of the Irish Free State in 1922, the legal architecture of the United Kingdom has recognized the sovereignty of the Irish state.[25] The phrase "British Isles" is virtually obsolete in modern UK statutes, and when it is used as a legal term, it is strictly interpreted to

mean the "British Islands" (i.e., excluding the Republic of Ireland).[27]
Therefore, the assertion that using the term "British Isles" is an insult to Irish sovereignty is based on a legal fiction. The geographical term (British Isles) includes Ireland, just as the geographical term "North America" includes Canada and Mexico. The legal term (British Islands) respects international borders and excludes Ireland.[26]

### 3.3 The Irish Government's Position as Political Propaganda

Despite these clear legal and historical demarcations, the Government of Ireland maintains an official policy of non-recognition regarding the term. In September 2005, the Irish Minister for Foreign Affairs stated: "The British Isles is not an officially recognised term in any legal or inter-governmental sense. It is without any official status. The Government, including the Department of Foreign Affairs, does not use this term".[5] Furthermore, the Irish embassy in London actively monitors and discourages its use in the media.[3]
This stance is purely political and acts as a form of state-sponsored propaganda. By insisting that Irish citizens should find the term offensive, the state attempts to rewrite the geographical dictionary to suit post-colonial sensitivities.[29] While the Irish government prefers terms like "Britain and Ireland" or "these islands" in joint documents (such as the Good Friday Agreement), these terms are politically negotiated euphemisms, not scientifically verified geographic classifications.[3] It is highly problematic for any nation's population to be instructed that it is "offensive" to use the universally recognized, verified name of the physical landmasses upon which they live.

## 4. Sociological Realities: British Identity is Not Equivocal to English Identity

A central pillar of the manufactured offense regarding the term "British Isles" is the conflation of the word "British" with the word "English." This equivocation is a severe sociological error that erases the identities of millions of people within the archipelago.
British identity is not a monolith; it is a multi-national, civic, and cultural umbrella.[31] The island of Great Britain alone comprises three distinctive ethnic and national identities: English, Welsh, and Scottish.[9]

- **Scotland:** Northern Britain was shaped by Pictish, Irish (Gaelic), and Scandinavian influences. Scotland maintains a fierce, independent national identity, its own legal system, and a devolved parliament (Holyrood). Scottish citizens are British, but they are absolutely not English.[9]
- **Wales:** The Welsh preserved their indigenous Celtic language more successfully than any other part of the archipelago. Their heritage is rooted in resistance to Anglo-Saxon incursions, and they maintain a distinct identity and devolved government (the Senedd). Welsh people are British, but they are not English.[9]
- **Northern Ireland:** Citizens of Northern Ireland hold complex identities, often identifying as Irish, British, or both. Their Britishness is tied to the civic structures of the UK, distinct

from Englishness.[33]

- **Isle of Man:** The Manx people, native to the Isle of Man, possess a rich Celtic culture and speak a Gaelic language. While they hold British citizenship, their primary identity is Manx, completely distinct from Anglo-Saxon English heritage.[18]

Sociological research indicates that English people frequently lack a clear distinction between English and British identities, often subsuming "British" under "English".[7] This "lordly English habit" causes significant irritation among the Scottish, Welsh, and Northern Irish.[7] However, the fact that some English people misuse the term does not alter its true definition.

Therefore, when the archipelago is described as the "British Isles," it is not declaring the islands to be *English* Isles. It is a reflection of the shared ancient British (Priteni), Celtic, and civic heritage that blankets the Scottish, Welsh, Manx, and historical Irish populations.[8] Demanding the abandonment of the term "British Isles" because one equates "British" with "English" is an insult to the millions of Scottish, Welsh, and Manx people who proudly hold British identity without being English.

# 5. International Maritime Law: The Irish Sea and the English Channel

To further dismantle the argument that geographic names imply sovereign ownership, one must examine the international laws and conventions governing the bodies of water within the British Isles. The waters of the archipelago are strictly defined by the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS) and the International Hydrographic Organization (IHO).

## 5.1 The Delineation of Maritime Borders (UNCLOS)

Under UNCLOS (1982), sovereign control over the ocean is rigidly quantified. Coastal states, including the UK and the Republic of Ireland, exercise full sovereignty only over their Territorial Sea, which extends a maximum of 12 nautical miles from their coastal baselines.[35] Beyond this, states hold economic rights within their 200-nautical-mile Exclusive Economic Zones (EEZ), but the waters themselves are open to the right of innocent passage by international shipping.[35] UNCLOS deals exclusively with the *legal status* of waters, not their *names*.[38] The naming of international waters is managed by the IHO, which prioritizes navigational safety and standardization over the political vanity of bordering nations.[39]

## 5.2 The Irish Sea and The English Channel: Toponymic Conventions

The IHO's authoritative publication, *Limits of Oceans and Seas* (Special Publication S-23), explicitly defines the names of the waters in the archipelago.[40]

1. **The Irish Sea:** The body of water measuring roughly 46,007 square kilometers that separates the islands of Ireland and Great Britain is officially verified and standardized globally as the **Irish Sea**.[42]
2. **The English Channel:** The narrow sea separating the southern coast of England from the

northern coast of France is standardized globally as the **English Channel**.[10]

These names are established international conventions—"that is just the law" of cartography.[43] Crucially, the naming convention has absolutely zero bearing on sovereign ownership.[11]

The fact that the sea between Great Britain and Ireland is called the "Irish Sea" does not mean that the Republic of Ireland owns the water up to the beaches of Liverpool or Wales. The UK exercises full territorial sovereignty over the eastern half of the Irish Sea.[11] Similarly, the fact that the water between London and Paris is called the "English Channel" does not mean England owns the waters off the coast of Normandy, France.[11]

If the Republic of Ireland can accept that the UK does not take offense to sharing the "Irish Sea"—understanding that it is merely a geographic identifier based on the presence of the island of Ireland—then the population of Ireland must logically accept that "British Isles" is merely a geographic identifier based on the presence of the largest island, Great Britain.[11] To accept one convention while claiming offense at the other is intellectually inconsistent and exposes the manufactured nature of the political outrage.

# 6. The 2026 Geopolitical Context: The Fallacy of the "Gulf of America"

The necessity of defending objective, verified geographic names like the "British Isles" against emotional or political revisionism has never been more vital than in the contemporary geopolitical climate of 2026. To understand the danger of allowing political offense to dictate cartography, one must analyze the recent actions of the United States government regarding the Gulf of Mexico.

## 6.1 Executive Order 14172: Unilateral Renaming

On January 20, 2025, during his second inauguration, U.S. President Donald Trump signed Executive Order 14172, titled "Restoring Names That Honor American Greatness".[12] This sweeping mandate directed the U.S. Secretary of the Interior and the U.S. Board on Geographic Names to officially alter the federal nomenclature of the U.S. Continental Shelf area of the Gulf of Mexico, renaming it the **"Gulf of America"**.[12]

President Trump's justification was overtly political and nationalistic. The administration argued that because the United States controls roughly 92% of the shoreline, and because the waters are an "indelible part of America" vital to the national economy, the name should reflect U.S. dominance rather than the neighboring country of Mexico.[44] The President even declared February 9, 2025, as the inaugural "Gulf of America Day," urging public officials to observe the new naming convention with patriotic ceremonies.[46]

By early 2026, the tangible effects of this policy were actively altering federal operations. The Bureau of Ocean Energy Management (BOEM) began scheduling massive oil and gas lease sales under the new name, designating the upcoming August 2026 sale as "Big Beautiful Gulf 3" (BBG3), actively erasing the "Mexico" designation from international energy markets.[47]

## 6.2 The Global Backlash to Cartographic Imperialism

The global reaction to Trump's "Gulf of America" mandate was swift and legally profound, demonstrating the international consensus against politically motivated toponymy.
The Mexican government, under President Claudia Sheinbaum, correctly identified the move as a violation of international norms. Pointing out that U.S. sovereignty is strictly limited by UNCLOS to 12 nautical miles from the coast, Sheinbaum initiated litigation against corporations like Google that attempted to adopt the U.S. naming mandate.[12] She highlighted the absurdity of the situation by sarcastically proposing that North America be renamed "Mexican America".[12]
Crucially, global entities and international media refused to adopt the name. The Associated Press (AP) updated its global style guide, stating definitively that it would continue to use the 400-year-old name, "Gulf of Mexico," noting that Trump's executive order carried zero authority outside the borders of the United States, and that international bodies were under no obligation to recognize it.[50] The United Kingdom government also officially declined to recognize "Gulf of America," relying on internationally accepted norms.[12]

## 6.3 The Parallel to the British Isles

The 2026 "Gulf of America" controversy is the perfect lens through which to view the "British Isles" debate.
Donald Trump's attempt to erase the "Gulf of Mexico" is universally recognized as an act of political theater, an attempt to use raw administrative power to project nationalistic ownership over a shared geographic space.[50] The world rejected it because the Gulf of Mexico is a verified, historical, and standardized geographical name that exists independently of modern political grievances or shoreline percentages.[50]
The campaign by the Irish government to erase the term "British Isles" relies on the exact same flawed logic as the "Gulf of America" mandate, simply functioning in reverse. The Irish government is attempting to leverage modern political sensitivities to unilaterally dismantle a verified, ancient, and internationally recognized geographical taxonomy.[6]
If it is absurd and legally baseless for Donald Trump to rename a shared body of water the "Gulf of America" simply because he wishes to project American identity, it is equally absurd and baseless for the Irish government to demand the erasure of the "British Isles" simply because they harbor historical grievances against the word "British." Geography must remain objective.

# 7. Conclusion: The Necessity of Geographic Objectivity

The archipelago situated in the North Atlantic is a profoundly complex web of overlapping physical geography and political jurisdictions. It contains thousands of islands, from the towering peaks of the Isle of Skye to the western frontiers of the Aran Islands, to the central Crown Dependency of the Isle of Man, and the southern outpost of the Isle of Wight.[4] To navigate this reality, science and cartography require a unifying macro-designator.
The verified, historical, and geographical name of this region is the **British Isles**.[3]

The assertion that the population of Ireland is "allowed to find it offensive" is a byproduct of political propaganda that deliberately conflates distinct concepts.[6] First, it ignores the legal reality that the United Kingdom uses the term "British Islands" to define its legal borders, explicitly excluding the Republic of Ireland.[25] Second, it relies on the sociologically illiterate assumption that "British" means "English," erasing the vibrant Scottish, Welsh, and Manx identities that proudly exist under the British civic umbrella.[7]

Third, and most importantly, it ignores the fundamental laws of international toponymy. The Irish Sea does not belong to Ireland, and the English Channel does not belong to England.[11] They are standardized names established for the cohesion of global mapping.

As the world witnesses the chaotic fallout of the 2026 "Gulf of America" debacle—where political vanity attempted to override cartographic reality—the population of Ireland, and the broader global community, must recognize that objective geography transcends modern politics.[12] It is not offensive to use the term "British Isles"; rather, it is scientifically, historically, and legally inaccurate *not* to use it. The verified name of the archipelago is the British Isles, and preserving that nomenclature is essential to maintaining the integrity of global geography.

### Works cited


1. Toponymy - Wikipedia, accessed February 21, 2026, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Toponymy
2. Our island's name · Saint Helena Island Info · About St Helena, in the South Atlantic Ocean, accessed February 21, 2026, https://sainthelenaisland.info/name.htm
3. British Isles - Wikipedia, accessed February 21, 2026, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/British_Isles
4. List of islands of the British Isles - Wikipedia, accessed February 21, 2026, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/List_of_islands_of_the_British_Isles
5. Official Terms. - Oireachtas.ie, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.oireachtas.ie/en/debates/question/2005-09-28/495/
6. Do You Object To The Term "The British Isles?" : r/AskIreland - Reddit, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.reddit.com/r/AskIreland/comments/1bskdb7/do_you_object_to_the_term_the_british_isles/
7. The Making of English National Identity - Assets - Cambridge University Press, accessed February 21, 2026, https://assets.cambridge.org/97805217/71887/sample/9780521771887ws.pdf
8. British people - Wikipedia, accessed February 21, 2026, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/British_people
9. How the Britons Became the English, the Welsh, and the Scottish: Creating a United Kingdom - Smithsonian Associates, accessed February 21, 2026, https://smithsonianassociates.org/ticketing/programs/how-britons-became-english-welsh-and-scottish-creating-united-kingdom
10. English Channel - Wikipedia, accessed February 21, 2026, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/English_Channel
11. In the October 1996 issue, National Geographic declined to rename the "Sea of

Japan" on its maps : r/korea - Reddit, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.reddit.com/r/korea/comments/i65p22/in_the_october_1996_issue_national_geographic/
12. Gulf of Mexico naming controversy - Wikipedia, accessed February 21, 2026, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gulf_of_Mexico_naming_controversy
13. Executive Order 14172 - Wikipedia, accessed February 21, 2026, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Executive_Order_14172
14. Great Britain - Wikipedia, accessed February 21, 2026, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Great_Britain
15. Is Ireland Part of the UK? Understanding the Division - Visit Portrush, accessed February 21, 2026, https://visitportrush.co.uk/is-ireland-part-of-the-uk-understanding-the-division/
16. The Islands of Britain – Where they are and Why they are Interesting - Great British Coast, accessed February 21, 2026, https://greatbritishcoast.com/islands-britain-where-interesting-british-coast/
17. Is the Isle of Wight part of Great Britain? - Quora, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.quora.com/Is-the-Isle-of-Wight-part-of-Great-Britain
18. Isle of Man – an overview, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.gov.im/about-the-government/departments/cabinet-office/media-centre/isle-of-man-an-overview/
19. Isle of Man - Wikipedia, accessed February 21, 2026, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Isle_of_Man
20. accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.gov.im/about-the-government/departments/cabinet-office/external-relations/constitution/#:~:text=The%20Isle%20of%20Man%20is%20an%20internally%20self%2Dgoverning%20dependency,their%20capacity%20as%20Privy%20Councillors.
21. Terminology of the British Isles - Wikipedia, accessed February 21, 2026, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Terminology_of_the_British_Isles
22. Terminology of the British Isles - Encyclopedia.pub, accessed February 21, 2026, https://encyclopedia.pub/entry/32614
23. Names of the British Isles - Wikipedia, accessed February 21, 2026, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Names_of_the_British_Isles
24. The difference between UK, Great Britain and the British Isles | Blog | OS - Ordnance Survey, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.ordnancesurvey.co.uk/blog/whats-the-difference-between-uk-britain-and-british-isles
25. British Islands - Wikipedia, accessed February 21, 2026, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/British_Islands
26. What's the Difference Between Great Britain and the UK? - Mental Floss, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.mentalfloss.com/geography/whats-difference-between-great-britain-and-uk
27. Law of the United Kingdom - Wikipedia, accessed February 21, 2026, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Law_of_the_United_Kingdom

28. Legal Definition of "Great Britain" - Law Stack Exchange, accessed February 21, 2026, https://law.stackexchange.com/questions/75330/legal-definition-of-great-britain
29. The difference between the UK, Britain, the British Isles, the North and South of Ireland explained | The Irish Post, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.irishpost.com/life-style/difference-uk-britain-british-isles-north-south-ireland-explained-irelands-complicated-history-85459
30. Unionism's Future Will Be Decided by Consent, Not Commentary... - Slugger O'Toole, accessed February 21, 2026, https://sluggerotoole.com/2026/02/12/unionism-isnt-fading-demographics-and-constitutional-debate/
31. British Social Attitudes 41 | National Identity, accessed February 21, 2026, https://natcen.ac.uk/publications/british-social-attitudes-41-national-identity
32. UK: National identity in Britain - Opinium, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.opinium.com/us/resource-center/national-identity-in-britain/
33. Do Scottish, Welsh and Northern Irish people identify themselves as British? Do they get offended when they are called "British"? : r/EnglishLearning - Reddit, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.reddit.com/r/EnglishLearning/comments/142ivlx/do_scottish_welsh_and_northern_irish_people/
34. Whither Britishness? English and Scottish people in Scotland*1 - ResearchGate, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.researchgate.net/publication/229876574_Whither_Britishness_English_and_Scottish_people_in_Scotland1
35. Maritime Jurisdiction Act 2021, Schedule 1 - Irish Statute Book, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2021/act/28/schedule/1/enacted/en/html
36. UN Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS) Maritime Boundaries Ireland, accessed February 21, 2026, https://edmed.seadatanet.org/report/6497/
37. United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.un.org/depts/los/convention_agreements/texts/unclos/unclos_e.pdf
38. scufn18-8.6a, accessed February 21, 2026, https://legacy.iho.int/mtg_docs/com_wg/SCUFN/SCUFN18/SCUFN18-8.6A_Geographic_Names_and_UNCLOS.pdf
39. STANDARDISATION OF GEOGRAPHICAL NAMES AT SEA: - International Cartographic Association, accessed February 21, 2026, https://icaci.org/files/documents/ICC_proceedings/ICC2001/icc2001/file/f04016.pdf
40. Standards and Specifications - IHO Publications, accessed February 21, 2026, https://iho.int/en/standards-and-specifications
41. Limits of Oceans and Seas - EPIC, accessed February 21, 2026, https://epic.awi.de/29772/1/IHO1953a.pdf
42. Irish Sea - Wikipedia, accessed February 21, 2026, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Irish_Sea
43. Naming objects beyond a single sovereignty - the United Nations, accessed

February 21, 2026, https://unstats.un.org/unsd/geoinfo/ungegn/docs/Training/Manila/3_Naming_objects_beyond_a_single_sovereignty.pdf
44. Restoring Names That Honor American Greatness - The White House, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2025/01/restoring-names-that-honor-american-greatness/
45. Gulf of America was almost named Gulf of Trump, reveals president - Investing.com, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.investing.com/news/economy-news/gulf-of-america-was-almost-named-gulf-of-trump-reveals-president-4456112
46. Gulf of America Day, 2025 - The White House, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2025/02/gulf-of-america-day-2025/
47. E&E News: BOEM sets Gulf of Mexico oil lease sale in August, accessed February 21, 2026, https://subscriber.politicopro.com/article/eenews/2026/02/19/boem-sets-gulf-of-mexico-oil-lease-sale-in-august-00788635
48. US sets the date for third Gulf of America oil & gas lease sale - Offshore-Energy.biz, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.offshore-energy.biz/us-sets-the-date-for-third-gulf-of-america-oil-gas-lease-sale/
49. “What's in a Name?” - Völkerrechtsblog, accessed February 21, 2026, https://voelkerrechtsblog.org/whats-in-a-name/
50. AP style guidance on Gulf of Mexico, Mount McKinley | The Associated Press, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.ap.org/the-definitive-source/announcements/ap-style-guidance-on-gulf-of-mexico-mount-mckinley/
51. Apparently calling it 'Gulf of America' is no longer cool - Chron, accessed February 21, 2026, https://www.chron.com/gulf-coast/article/trump-renaming-president-mexico-america-21306764.php